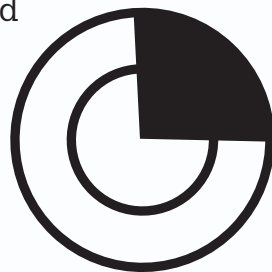




AIR FORCE AIRMAN

JOB DESCRIPTION

Air Force airmen fly some of the most advanced aircraft in the world. They provide defense and safety for national airspace, serving at home and abroad. Airmen operate weapons and perform defense tactics for air and ground targets. From conducting search and rescue missions to giving humanitarian aid, airmen serve one of the most powerful military operations in the world.



SALARY

Enlisted airman ★★★★★

Chief of staff ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Highly competitive entry • With a small force and a large number of applicants, there are fewer opportunities, which can result in a wait for joining this branch of the military

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **AIRLINE PILOT** *see pp. 214–215*
- ▶ **ARMY SOLDIER** *see pp. 230–231*
- ▶ **HELICOPTER PILOT** Flies helicopters and can choose from a variety of work such as cargo delivery, law enforcement, firefighting, search and rescue, emergency medical services, and aerial photography. Training is expensive and working hours can be irregular. Fewer companies operate helicopters than planes; opportunities are scarce.

The first female fighter pilot in the US Air Force entered training in 1993.

AT A GLANCE



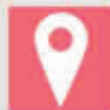
YOUR INTERESTS Aviation • Serving your country • Mathematics • Engineering • Technology • Firefighting



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Age, education, and residency requirements must be met in order to join the military. Physical and written exams are required.



LIFESTYLE The job is highly varied, with a range of intellectual and physical demands. Working hours are long when on operations.



LOCATION Airmen live, work, and train on or near military bases and facilities around the globe. They can expect to travel anywhere in the world.



THE REALITIES Navigating top-secret missions is stressful and high-risk. Airmen work long hours and are away from home and family often.